- Data is generated throughout the entire development process without a unified view.

All of these are common problems that deserve exploring.

1.2.1. Problem: agile definitions of measurement are not straightforward

There are a few commonly accepted tenets about measuring agile that tend to be rather confusing. Let's start with common agile principles:

- ***Working software is the primary measure of progress.*** That statement is so ambiguous and open to interpretation that it makes it very hard for teams to pinpoint exactly how to measure progress. Essentially the point is you are performing well if you're delivering products to your consumers. The problem is the subjective nature of the term *working software*. Are you delivering something that works per the original requirements but has massive security holes that put your consumer's data in jeopardy? Are you delivering something that is so non-performant that your consumers stop using it? If you answered yes to either question, then you're probably not progressing. There's a lot more to measuring progress than delivering working software.
- ***Any measurement you're currently using has to be cheap.*** So what's included in the cost associated with gathering metrics? Are licenses to software included? Are you looking at the hours spent by the people collecting measures? This statement belittles the value of measuring performance. When you start measuring something, the better thing to keep in mind is if the value you get from the improvement associated with the metric outweighs the cost of collecting it. This open statement is a good tenet, but like our first statement, it's pretty ambiguous.
- ***Measure only what matters.*** This is a bad tenet. How do you know what matters? When do you start tracking new things and when do you stop tracking others? Because these are hard questions, metrics end up getting thrown by the wayside when they could be providing value. A better wording would be "measure everything and figure out why metrics change unexpectedly."